

Lab 2: Agile Backlog Creation & Sprint Simulation in Jira

Problem Statement #60 — Podcast Guest Scheduling & Outline Builder

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Program	HPE Carrier Preview Program
Project Scenario	Podcast Guest Scheduling & Outline Builder (Problem #60)
Jira Project	Podcast Guest Scheduling & Outline Builder (Key: PGSOB)
Board URL	ashithraok.atlassian.net/jira/software/projects/PGSOB/boards/3

1. Objective

This lab applies Agile backlog management using Jira. The functional and non-functional requirements identified in Lab 1 for the Podcast Guest Scheduling & Outline Builder system were converted into Epics and User Stories, prioritized, estimated using story points, and executed through a simulated sprint. Progress was tracked using Jira's Board and Burndown Chart.

2. Epics and Backlog

The Lab 1 functional requirements were broken down into three Epics, each populated with related User Stories in the Jira backlog:

Epic	User Stories (Jira Keys)	Total Story Points
Guest Booking & Content Submission	PGSOB-4 Select Available Interview Slot PGSOB-5 Submit Discussion Topic Bullet Points PGSOB-6 Submit Biography Link	8
Host Scheduling Management	PGSOB-7 Add Available Interview Slots PGSOB-8 Block Unavailable Dates and Time Slots PGSOB-9 Reschedule Confirmed Booking PGSOB-10 View Confirmed Guest Bookings	13
Run-of-Show Production	PGSOB-11 Compile Guest Topics into Production Sheet	5

Screenshot below shows the full product backlog with all 10 work items grouped under their respective Epics, along with story point estimates and status.

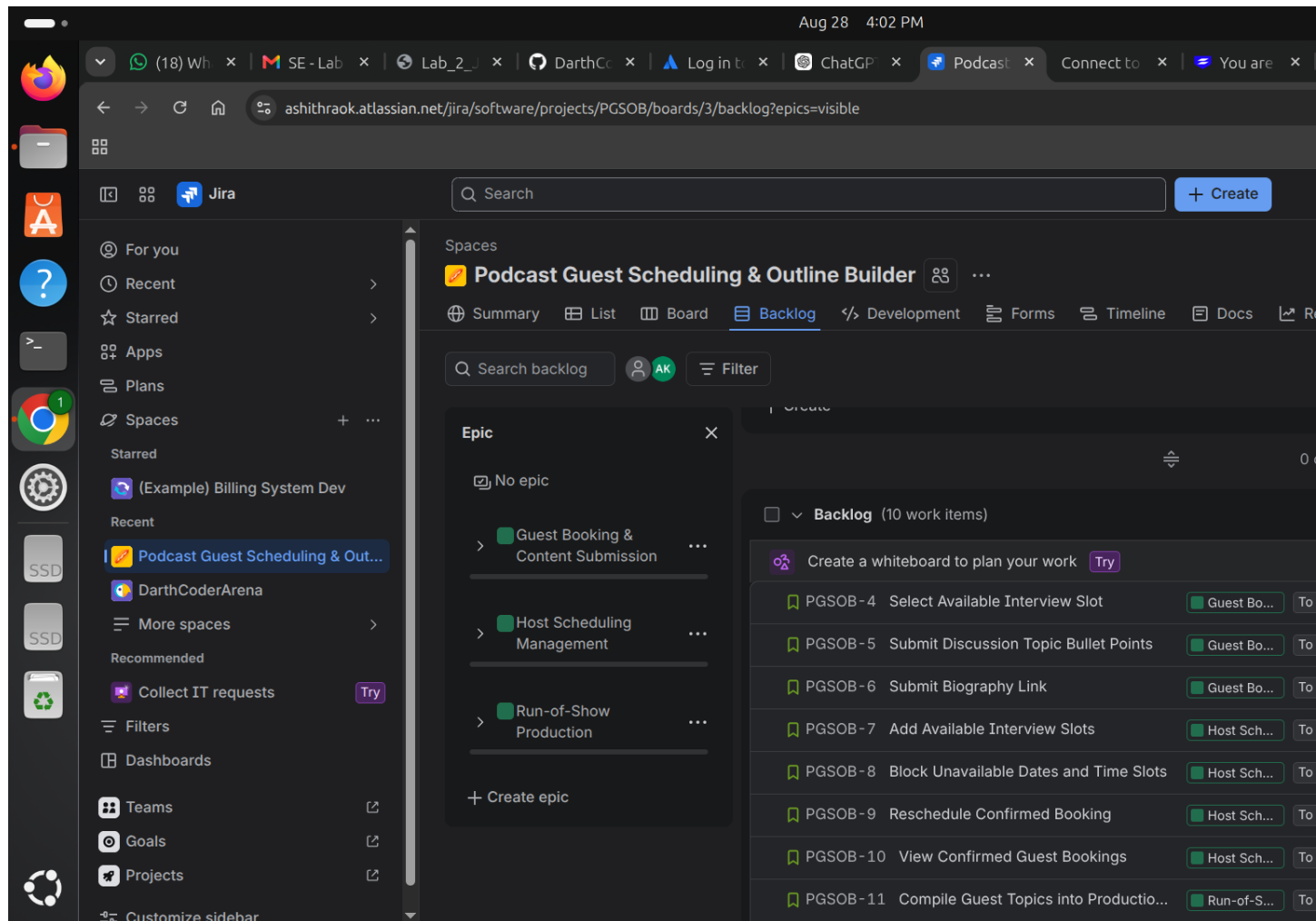


Figure 1: Jira Backlog — Epics and User Stories for PGSOB project

3. Story Point Estimation

Story points were assigned to each User Story using the Fibonacci sequence (1, 2, 3, 5, 8 ...), reflecting relative effort, complexity, and uncertainty rather than absolute time. Estimates were entered directly against each backlog item via the Story Point Estimate field.

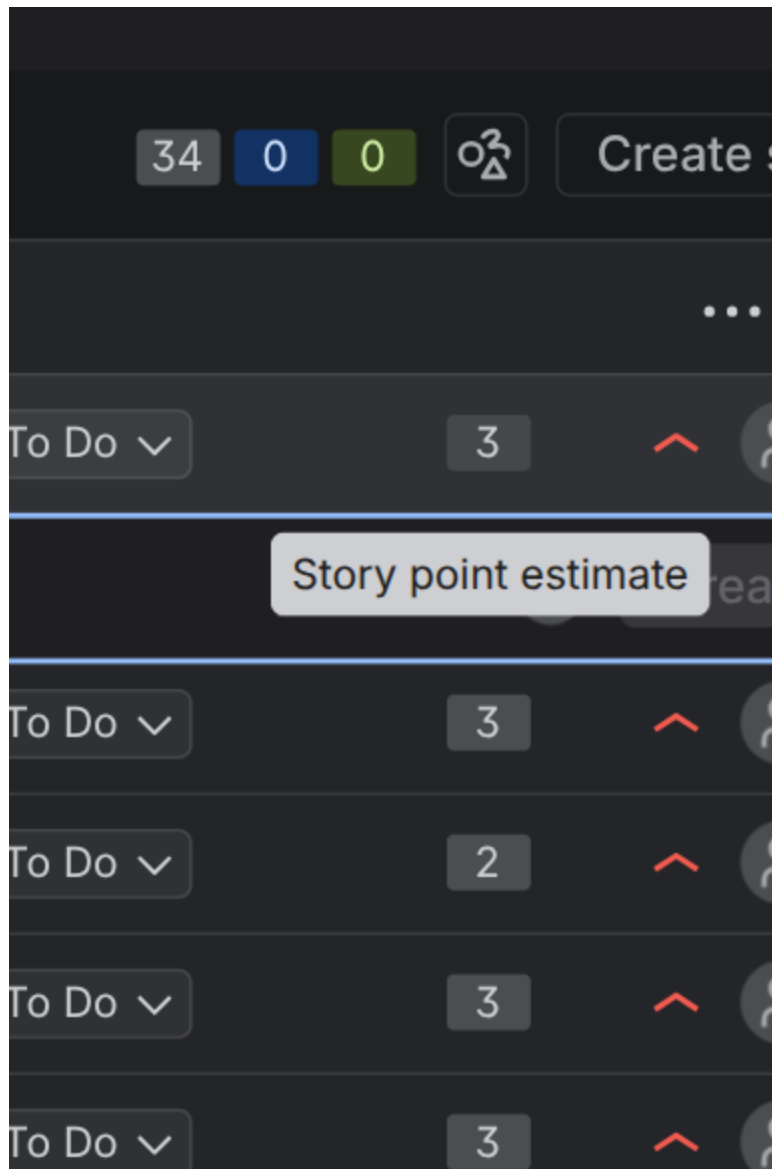


Figure 2: Story point estimates assigned to backlog items

4. Sprint Execution — Active Sprint Board

PGSOB Sprint 1 was created with a one-week duration and populated with four User Stories drawn from the backlog. Tasks were then progressed across the board — To Do → In Progress → In Review → Done — to simulate real sprint activity.

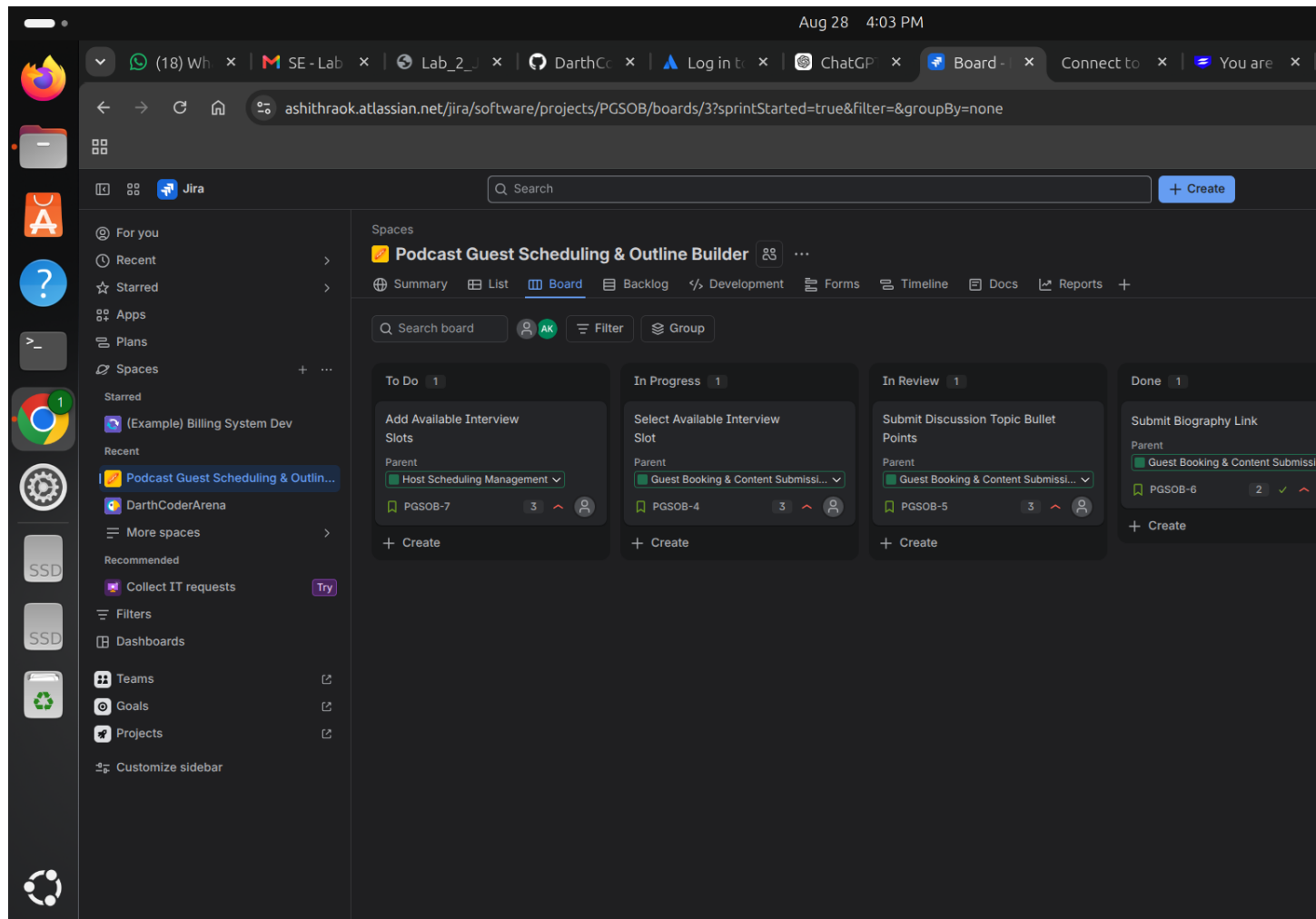


Figure 3: Active Sprint board showing task progression across To Do, In Progress, In Review, and Done

By the end of the simulated sprint, "Add Available Interview Slots" (PGSOB-7) remained in To Do, "Select Available Interview Slot" (PGSOB-4) was In Progress, "Submit Discussion Topic Bullet Points" (PGSOB-5) was In Review, and "Submit Biography Link" (PGSOB-6) was moved to Done.

5. Burndown Chart

The Sprint Burndown Chart was generated from Reports → Burndown Chart for PGSOB Sprint 1, tracking remaining story points against the ideal guideline burn rate across the sprint window (August 28 – September 11, 2026).

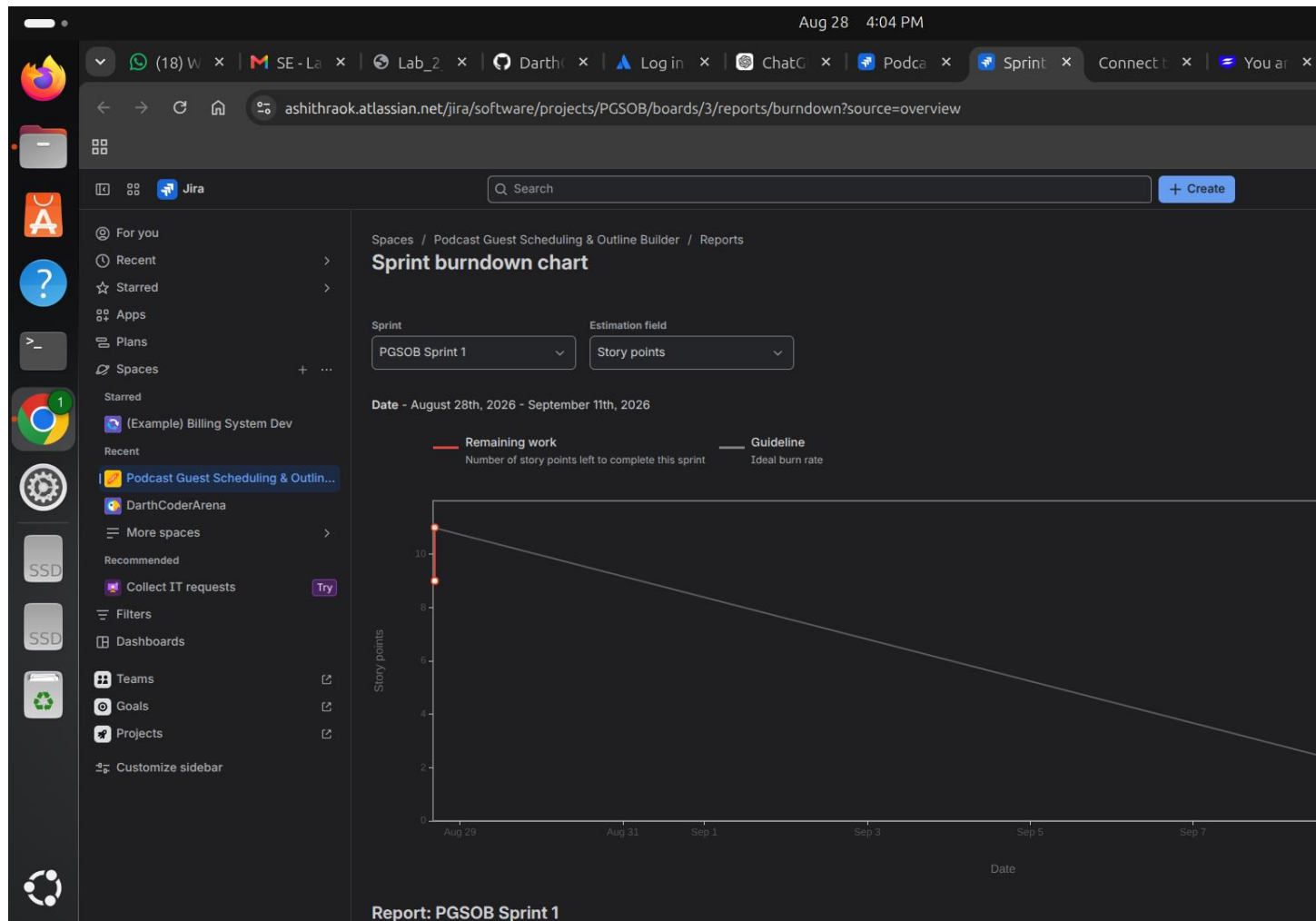


Figure 4: Sprint burndown chart — remaining work vs. ideal guideline

6. Reflection Questions

6.1 Did your estimations reflect the actual effort?

The story points assigned (2–5 points per story) were broadly consistent with each story's actual scope. Simpler, single-field submissions such as "Submit Biography Link" were estimated lowest at 2 points, while multi-step scheduling stories such as "Reschedule Confirmed Booking" were estimated higher at 5 points, reflecting the added logic of validating slot availability and updating existing bookings.

6.2 Was your backlog well-prioritized?

The backlog was organized so that guest-facing booking and submission stories (Guest Booking & Content Submission epic) and host availability controls (Host Scheduling Management epic) were prioritized ahead of downstream production tasks (Run-of-Show Production epic), since guests cannot book a slot until the host has configured availability, and the production sheet cannot be compiled until guest topics have been submitted. This ordering matches the dependency chain identified in the Lab 1 use-case flow.

6.3 How did your simulated sprint align with your plan?

Sprint 1 was planned with a one-week duration and a focused set of stories from the Guest Booking & Content Submission and Host Scheduling Management epics. During simulation, one story completed fully (Done), one reached In Review, one was In Progress, and one remained in To Do by the sprint's midpoint — a realistic distribution that mirrors how a real sprint rarely finishes with every item complete on the first pass.

6.4 What insights did the burndown chart give about your team's capacity?

The burndown chart's remaining-work line tracked close to the ideal guideline for the early part of the sprint, indicating the committed story points were roughly appropriately scoped for the sprint window. Continued monitoring across future sprints would help confirm a stable velocity and reveal whether the team is consistently over- or under-committing during sprint planning.

7. Conclusion

This lab demonstrated the end-to-end Agile backlog workflow in Jira — from decomposing requirements into Epics and User Stories, prioritizing and estimating the backlog, running a simulated sprint, and analyzing progress via the burndown chart. The exercise reinforced how Agile ceremonies (backlog refinement, planning poker estimation, and sprint reviews) connect requirements engineering to iterative software delivery.